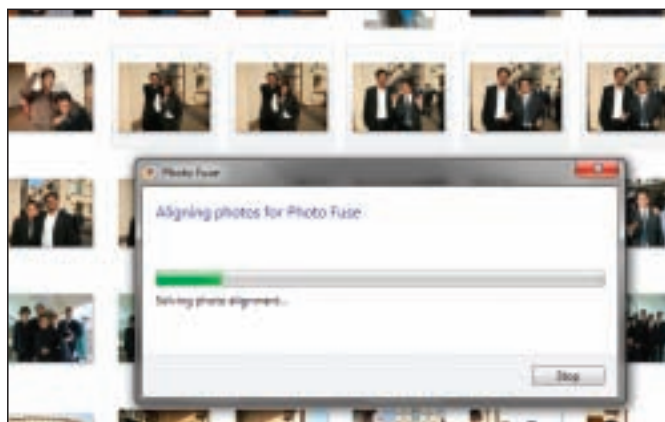




Choose a number of photos to fuse

be presented with the selection window where you can highlight the portions you're not satisfied with (example applications include a person with eyes blinking, or powerlines across your photo), and select from the pop-up window the portion that you prefer. You can do this to as many areas as you like, and Photo Gallery will automatically "fuse" that portion into the composite image you're

exposure, color correction, and even noise reduction. Buttons let you apply fixes automatically, but a "Fine tune" button offers deeper control (such as an adjustable histogram, highlights, shadows, sharpness, and color temperature). This version adds a new tool: Blemish removal, which worked well



The create toolbar

working on. Once you're satisfied with the result, just click on "Save" and you've got that perfect shot! Pretty impressive, eh? A word of warning though: Its comparable to what you find in Adobe Photoshop Elements, and the results were intriguing but not perfect—some people ended up with big hair, or worse, two ears on one side of the head.

Jazz up your photos

Windows Live Photo Gallery Wave 4 lets you jazz up your photos with a lot of photo adjustments like cropping, red-eye fixing, straightening,

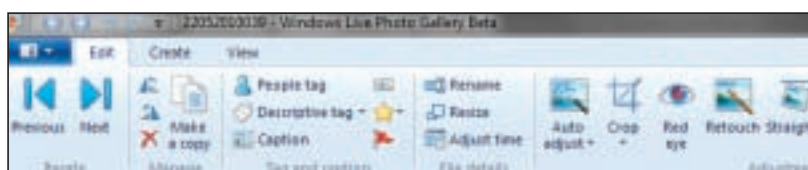
in my test, as did the red-eye fix. An Auto-adjust option will let you configure what you want fixed—any combination of exposure, color, NR, and straightening. The editing is non-destructive, so, at any point, you can revert to the original. You can even use the new batch edit tool that lets you apply fixes to a bunch of selected images at once, but it only works with the auto-fixes—color, exposure, straightening, and noise reduction—not with the

fine-tuning. Sometimes your photos are not straight and are tilted because of wrongly holding the camera. So for such photos there's a 'Straighten photo' option provided. Also there's a new option of giving your Photos 'Black and White effects' so that you can give an antique look to your photos.

Retouch Photos

You vacation photos don't look as good as they should because of that spot or blemish on your face? Windows Live Photo

your family and friends? Windows Live Photo Gallery comes to your rescue. Just highlight the photos you want or [Ctrl] + Select, click on Slideshow from the ribbon, choose your Slideshow theme choose from six themes, including pan and zoom, contemporary, sepia, and cinematic and then click on Share Slideshow which lets you upload it to either your SkyDrive, Facebook, YouTube or Windows Live Groups to share with family and friends.



The edit toolbar

Gallery lets you retouch your images and make them disappear. Select the photo you want to retouch, click on the View tab and select Zoom in so that you can view the blemish or mark close up. Then click on the Edit followed by Retouch. Now simply drag the cursor around the spot or blemish and it will magically disappear, so that all of your photos and those of your nearest and dearest will look perfect.

You can even choose to Photo e-mail which will use your default mail client to create a message that doesn't attach the photos, but instead links to an online gallery hosted on Windows Live SkyDrive, which is great for saving your recipient's inbox from large attachment clutter. Plain old attachments are still an option, too, though, and the choice between this and photo mail is clearly labeled.

Make Slideshows and Movies

Need to quickly create a fantastic looking slideshow of selected photos to share with

Integrate with Photosynth and other software

You can now integrate Windows Live Photo Gallery with other Microsoft Labs softwares like PhotoSynth, AutoCollage 2008, Pro Photo Tools, Image Composite Editor (ICE) and a few others. Just install them and they will automatically appear in the Extras Menu of Photo Gallery. It is not yet tightly integrated, but nevertheless, it's a step forward towards total integration.



Uploading an image to facebook